

ReclaimKit - VPS Guide

ReclaimKit contributors

Cheap VPS guide — ReclaimKit + other automations

Run ReclaimKit daily monitoring on a small VPS (~£4-6/month). Same server can host other Docker tools, scripts, and self-hosted AI.

Recommended providers (UK/EU, good for NI users)

Provider	Price	Specs (typical)	Best for
Hetzner Cloud	~£4.50/mo (CX22)	2 vCPU, 4 GB RAM, 40 GB SSD, EU datacentres	Best value — Docker, cron, multiple containers
DigitalOcean	~\$6/mo	1 vCPU, 1 GB RAM (basic droplet)	Simple UI, good docs
Vultr	~\$6/mo	1 vCPU, 1 GB RAM	Many regions
Oracle Cloud Free Tier	£0 (always free)	Up to 4 ARM cores, 24 GB RAM (if approved)	Free but signup/setup can be awkward

Recommendation: Hetzner CX22 (~€4.59/month) — enough RAM for ReclaimKit + Docker Compose stack + lightweight automation.

What fits on one £5 VPS

Service	RAM	Notes
ReclaimKit (Docker cron)	~100 MB	This repo — daily monitor + Slack
Ollama (free local AI)	2-4 GB	Run Llama/Mistral — needs CX22 or larger
n8n / Node-RED	~512 MB	Workflow automation
Uptime Kuma	~128 MB	Site monitoring
WireGuard VPN	~64 MB	Secure remote access
Static websites	minimal	nginx + small apps

Use **Docker Compose** to run several services on one VPS.

Free AI on a VPS

Option	Cost	Setup
Ollama (self-hosted)	Free (your VPS cost)	<code>curl -fsSL https://ollama.com/install.sh sh</code> then <code>ollama run llama3.2</code>
OpenRouter free tier	Free API credits	Call from Python scripts on VPS
Google Gemini API	Free tier limits	API key in <code>.env</code>

For ReclaimKit itself you do **not** need AI — letters are pre-written templates.

Quick Hetzner setup

1. Create account at hetzner.com → Cloud → Create server (Ubuntu 24.04, CX22, Falkenstein or Helsinki)
2. SSH in: `ssh root@YOUR_IP`
3. Install Docker:

```
apt update && apt install -y git docker.io docker-compose-v2
git clone https://github.com/tgollogly/ReclaimKit.git ~/reclaimkit
cd ~/reclaimkit
cp config.example.yaml config.yaml
nano config.yaml           # real email, meta_reports, post_origin: uncertain
mkdir -p evidence/screenshots output
python3 main.py init 2>/dev/null || pip3 install -r requirements.txt
python3 main.py campaign init
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
cd deploy && docker compose up -d --build
./scripts/check-autosave.sh      # verify autosave
```

4. Slack webhook in `config.yaml` for daily alerts
5. Optional `.env` for SMTP auto-email

Data persistence (auto-save)

Enabled by default. Docker bind-mounts host folders — nothing is stored only inside the container.

Host path (laptop or VPS)	What is saved
<code>~/reclaimkit/config.yaml</code>	Your details
<code>~/reclaimkit/output/</code>	Letters, <code>campaign/state.json</code> , cron logs
<code>~/reclaimkit/evidence/</code>	Screenshots

Verify anytime:

```
cd ~/reclaimkit && ./scripts/check-autosave.sh
```

See `deploy/docker-compose.yml` and `deploy/README.md`.

Security

- SSH keys only (disable password login)
- Firewall: `ufw allow 22 && ufw enable`
- Never commit `config.yaml` or `.env`
- Keep VPS patched: `apt upgrade -y weekly`

Cost summary

Item	Monthly
Hetzner CX22	~£4.50
ReclaimKit software	£0
SerpAPI (optional image search)	\$0-50
Total minimum	~£5

Compare to Removify: **£400-£2,000 per item.**